sense that it will be sufficiently credible that adversaries are not attempted to undertake prohibited actions and stable in the sense that it will be reassuring enough to reduce any incentives to launch a pre-emptive strike out of fear.[39] Deterrence or dissuasion is easier to achieve than compellance. In Vietnam the Americans faced not only the task of compelling a particular action but also of promoting an effective political order which was hard to achieve. The Cuban Missile Crisis was a test of nerves and undoubtedly it proved that possession of nuclear arsenal is not a decisive factor. From these arguments many scholars conclude that utility of military forces has been reduced in this nuclear age because:

- Nuclear might of one superpower balances that of the other. Therefore, their effective power is reduced to zero. The best and distinctive forces are least usable. As John Herz remarked, “Absolute power equals absolute impotence”.
- The fear of escalation strongly inhibits even the use of conventional forces,especially by the USA or the Soviet Union. Nuclear powers must fear escalation more than other states, for, in any war that rises to the nuclear level, they will be primarily targeted. They may resort to conventioal forces, but the risks in doing so are higher than in the past. Besides, in the nuclear age, enormous military power no longer ensures effective control over even the most feeble opponents.
- The weak states of the world have tried to change world opinion by asking the powerful nations to exercise restraint on the use of force, either nuclear or conventional.[40]

The given arguments might give us the impression that advent of nuclear and thermonuclear weapons has imposed new restraints upon those who control them and has undermined the utility of military power. But in the true sense, as Garnett[41] puts it, states have developed strategies that emphasize the “political uses” of military power even in war itself. T.C.Schelling (1966) has defined war as a “bargaining process” or a sort of “tough negotiation” and as